In fact, Captain Ravindran of the NSG had asked Vijay Karan whether he had the authority to act the moment they tracked down the fugitives. The idea was to figure out a way to bypass the local police. Tracking teams can usually take calls on their own and do not need the approval of the top bosses, but in the case of the Rajiv Gandhi assassination, there had been several lapses and failures in catching the fugitives, which had resulted in a lot of criticism in the media and in Parliament. Naturally, it had been demoralizing to the team. Karan's reply was that if the choice was between 'One-Eyed Jack killed' and 'One-Eyed Jack escaping', he would opt for the latter as it would give them another chance to catch Sivarasan alive. The top cop's response brought the officers no satisfaction.

The tracking team had only a section of the Black Cats available in Konanakunte. But within a couple of hours, the rest of the NSG team had assembled in Bangalore and was on operational alert. The commissioner of police, DCP Crime, Sri Kumar, Verma, Ravindran and Ragothaman sat together and went through all the options available to them. They admitted that the element of surprise had been lost. Nevertheless, whatever little chance they had of catching at least some of them alive and seizing at least some documents or records intact lay in a quick operation.

The Black Cats, in a separate conversation, told Ravindran to keep the police away, so they could enter through the windows with the cyanide antidote kits, and if Sivarasan did bite his cyanide capsule, treat him without losing more than ten to thirty seconds, depending on how far Sivarasan was from the window. They felt that Sivarasan would never reach for his cyanide capsule until he had seen the commandos barge into the house. The last thing a mastermind like him would want was to die by suicide. The commandos looked really charged, and that, in turn, raised the SIT officers' hope of catching Sivarasan alive.[6]

Kaarthikeyan was in Hyderabad. Around midnight Sri Kumar telephoned him and briefed him on the situation in Bangalore. Kaarthikeyan felt there was no point in wasting any more time—they should strike immediately. He, however, added with a note of caution that the CBI director should be consulted before the strike. Vijay Karan was in Delhi at